# Getting Gas: Outreach and Engagement ⛽

## Introduction 👋

You've built an amazing high-performance vehicle. Your LinkedIn profile is fully optimized to capture attention and establish credibility. You also now have a strong content strategy pumping out relevant, valuable posts consistently. And, most importantly, you've got a rock-solid mindset that is unshakeable, even on the slowest of days.

So - by about now, you may actually start to see some traction. People viewing your profile, engaging with your posts, checking out your website, taking your lead magnets, all of the good things. This is fantastic. But - things just aren't moving as fast as you'd like them to.

That's where outreach and engagement come in.

## Overview 👁️

Here's what we'll cover:

- **Why Outreach & Engagement Add Gas to Your LinkedIn Growth Engine 🚗**
- **Crafting a Target Account List 🎯**
- **Automating Personalized Outreach Sequences 🤖**
- **Optimizing Your AI Value Proposition Messaging 💬**
- **Implementing an AI-Focused Engagement Strategy 👥**
- **Leveraging Shared Content in Your Outreach 📎**

By the end of this video, you'll have a streamlined system for identifying and engaging high-value prospects - at scale.

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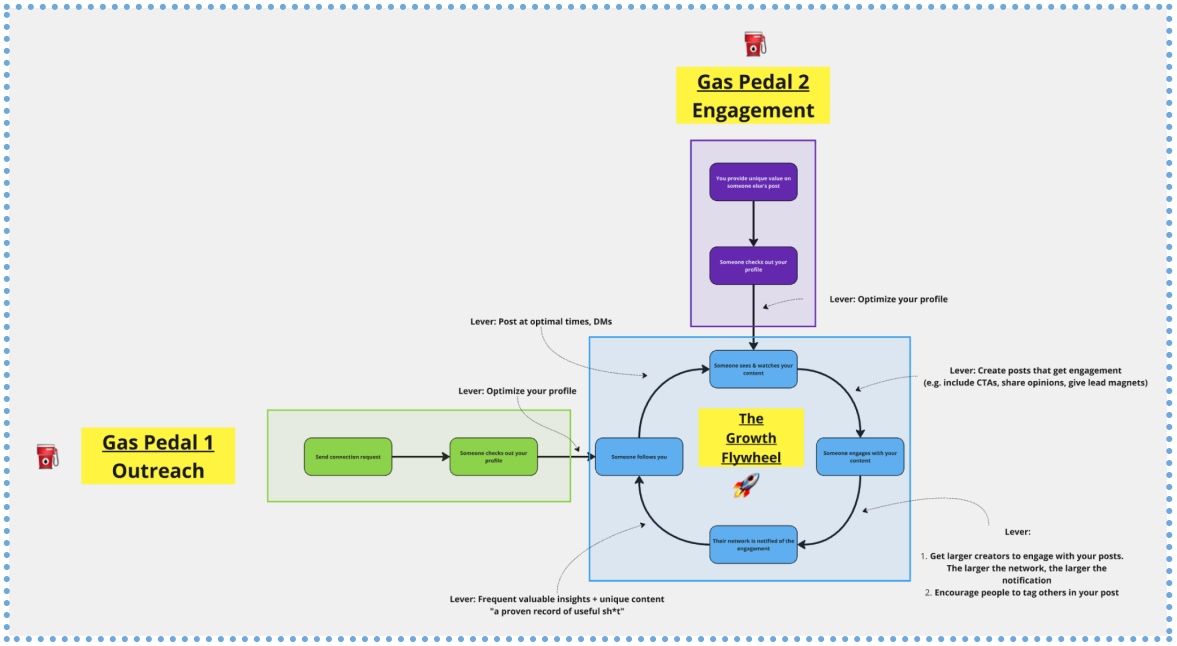
# Why Outreach & Engagement? 🚗

To understand why outreach and engagement act as fuel for sustainable LinkedIn growth, it helps to revisit the core LinkedIn Growth Flywheel we defined earlier:




**Someone follows you → Someone sees & watches your content → Someone engages with your content → Conversation started → Deal closed**

This sequence represents the flywheel that continuously spins to drive LinkedIn growth.

Outreach and engagement feed directly into the first stage of that flywheel - getting people to follow you & see your content. They get more of your target customers paying attention and interacting with your brand.

Without sufficient prospect attention and engagement, your LinkedIn funnel dries up. Fewer potential customers enter the top of the funnel, meaning fewer quality leads to nurture and fewer sales to close each month.

That flywheel grinds to a halt.

But strategic outreach and engagement keep targeted prospects continually flowing into your ecosystem. The flywheel accelerates as more qualified leads see & follow your content, therefore entering your funnel.

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# Crafting a Target Account List 🎯

Now, how do you decide exactly who you should be connecting with? Should you just be connecting with anyone and everyone who you think is a good target?

They say that "80% of your sales come from 20% of your prospects." This vital 20% represents your best-fit potential customers with the highest likelihood to buy from you.

Your outreach strategy should focus like a laser on engaging these high-value prospects. That starts with identifying and documenting your "dream list" of target accounts.

## How to Create an Outreach List, The Right Way 👫

Hands down, the best and most efficient way to create an outreach list on LinkedIn is through LinkedIn Sales Navigator.

Yes, it is a paid product and yes it does cost about $99/mo. It's not cheap. But there is no other tool out there that will give you as accurate of data with as many filters as Sales Nav. If you want to take outreach seriously (and if you want to grow fast, you should), then Sales Nav is a must-have.

You can try using LinkedIn's native free search function. This works to some degree, but the targeting is nowhere near as precise. What that manifests itself as is - poor response rates, poor connection rates, and overall more time wasted.

In this section, I'm going to give you a crash course on how to most effectively build your outreach list.

Here is a step-by-step process for compiling a targeted outreach list:

## Step 1: Define Your Ideal Customer Profile (ICP) 👤

Get very clear on the specific titles, industries, company sizes and business challenges of your best-fit prospects. Create an "avatar" representing this ideal target customer.

Hint: You should have already done this in our prior videos.

If you haven't, provide details of your ICP to ChatGPT or Claude, and ask it to provide you with a detailed ICP Avatar.

*Ex: Director of Marketing at retail e-commerce companies with 200-500 employees within the US, Canada, Australia and New Zealand.*

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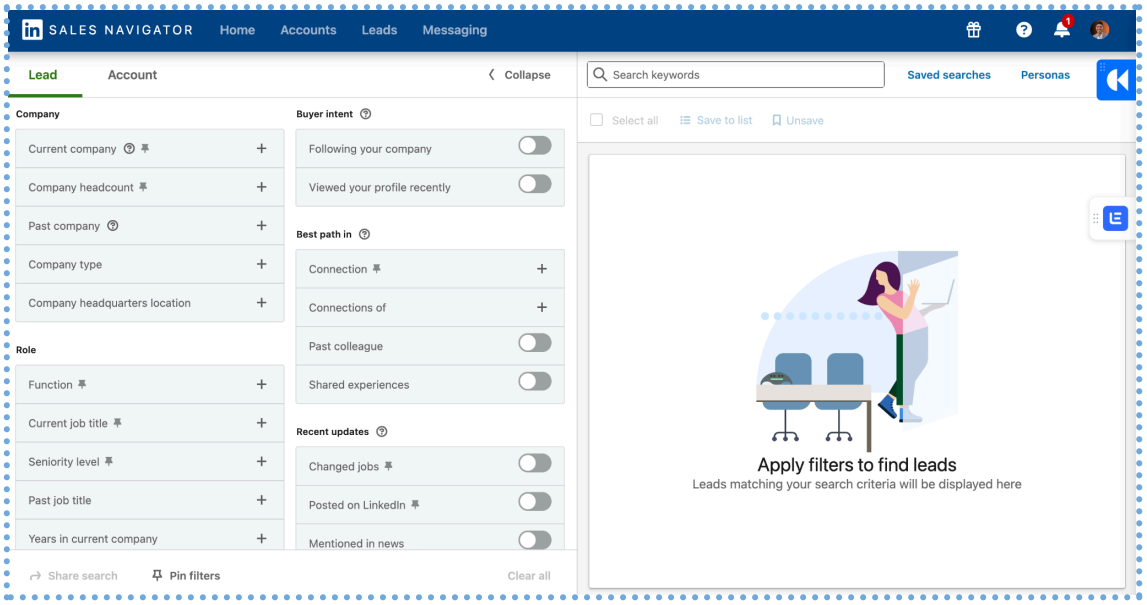
## Step 2: Leverage LinkedIn Sales Navigator to Search Companies 🕵️

Go to the 'Leads' tab. Use the advanced search filters and lists within Sales Navigator to identify companies that match your ICP criteria.

For example:

- ***Industry:*** *Retail & e-commerce*
- ***Headcount:*** *10-200 employees*
- ***Job Title:*** *Director of Marketing, VP Marketing, CMO*
- ***Location:*** *US, Canada, Australia, New Zealand*




**Hint**: To arrive at more specific filters, feed ChatGPT or Claude your ICP Avatar, and ask it to generate LinkedIn Sales Navigator filters for your avatar.

## Step 3: Pull Target Account Lists 💾

Pull those leads into your CRM or tracking spreadsheet to manage and track outreach progress.

You can also upload this list directly into your outreach tool (more on this later).

Following this process allows you to strategically identify your best-fit prospects and centralize them within your CRM for streamlined outreach.

Now let's look at how to engage these high-value accounts using automated outreach sequences.

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# Automating Outreach Sequences 🤖

## Why Automate Your Outreach? 🦾

The most effective way to drive leads from your outreach efforts is to nurture prospects using automated, multi-touch campaigns.

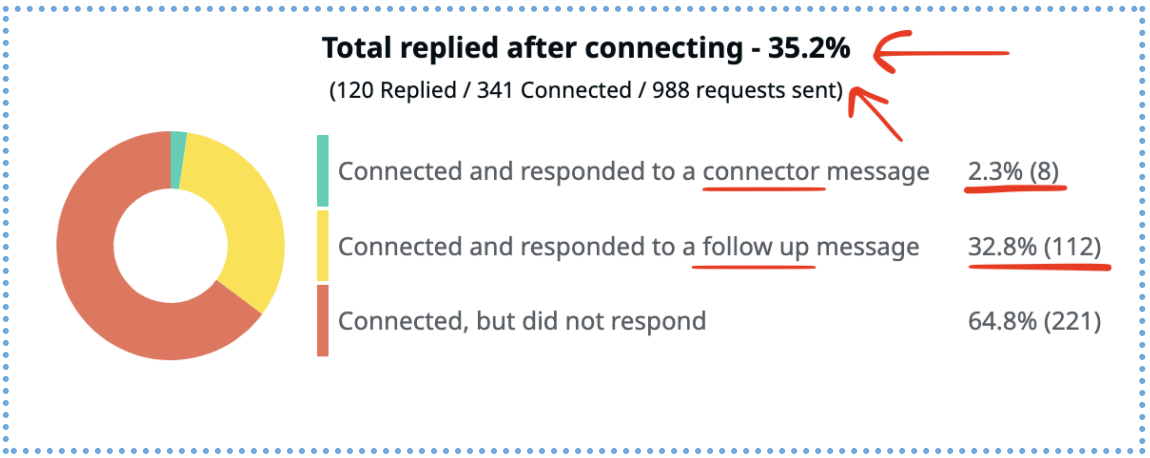
These structured sequences allow you to engage target accounts across multiple channels while delivering personalized value focused on AI solutions.

Now, you could absolutely do this manually too. You could create a spreadsheet with your target leads, manually track which leads you've reached out to, which have accepted your connection request, which require follow ups, etc.

But, as you can imagine, this process gets time consuming and very difficult to track.

So - I absolutely recommend using an automation tool like Expandi.io (Dripify, HeyReach, La Growth Machine are also top-tier) to do automated outreach & follow ups for you.

To show you that I'm not bluffing, here is a screenshot of an active campaign I have running where I'm getting 35%+ response rates:

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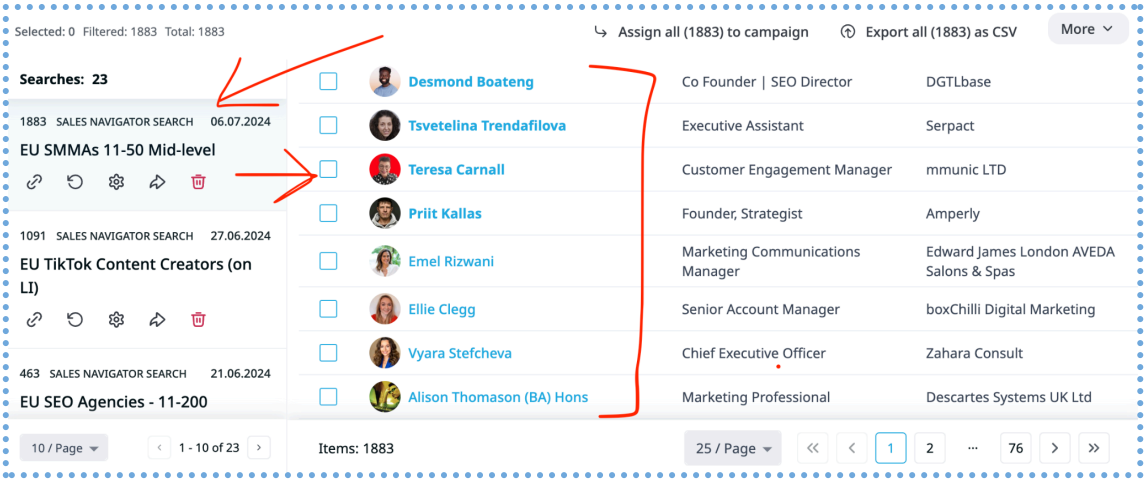
## Step-By-Step Automated Outreach Framework ⭐

Here is a framework for developing automated outreach sequences:

### Step 1: Upload Your Target List 🎯

Refer to your previously exported target account lists within your LinkedIn Sales Nav to select the companies you want to outreach.

Upload it directly into your outreach automation tool.




### Step 2: Initiate Sequence with Automated Connection Requests ✉️

Sending connection requests is the first step. There are constant debates going on around if you should or should not include a connection request message in your request.

Currently, I am advising folks to NOT include a connection request message in their outreach. This is based on data on currently what is working best for me and my clients at the moment.

However, this is marketing after all. You can experiment with this and try different approaches.

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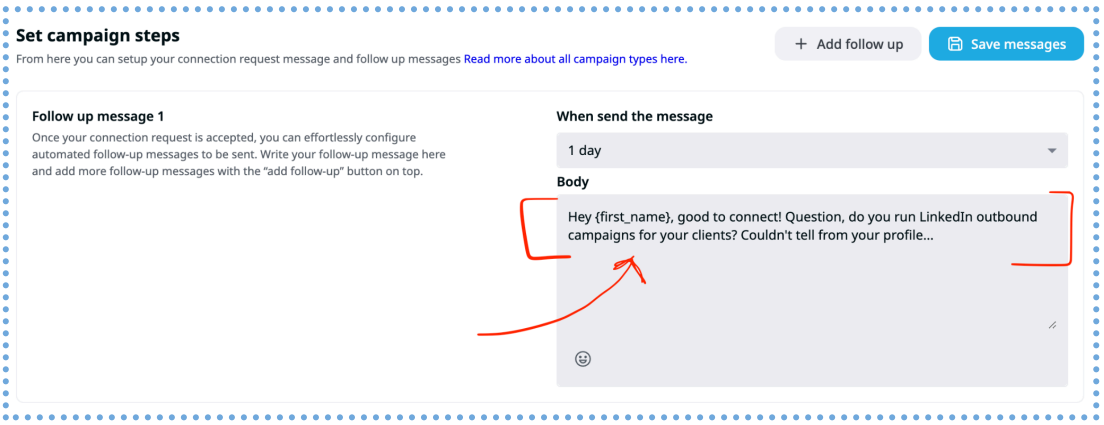
## Step 3: Send Initial Curiosity or Value-Driven Follow-up Message 💬

Once connected, send an initial follow-up message focused on providing unique value aligned with challenges faced by the prospect's role or industry, OR driving curiosity in their business.




For example: ask a provoking/relevant question, share a relevant case study or, even better, LinkedIn post of yours that speaks to a very specific problem your prospect might have. Do NOT go straight in for a discovery call here. Remember, your goal is just to start a conversation. Forget the sale.

## Step 4: Follow Up, Follow Up, Follow Up 📧

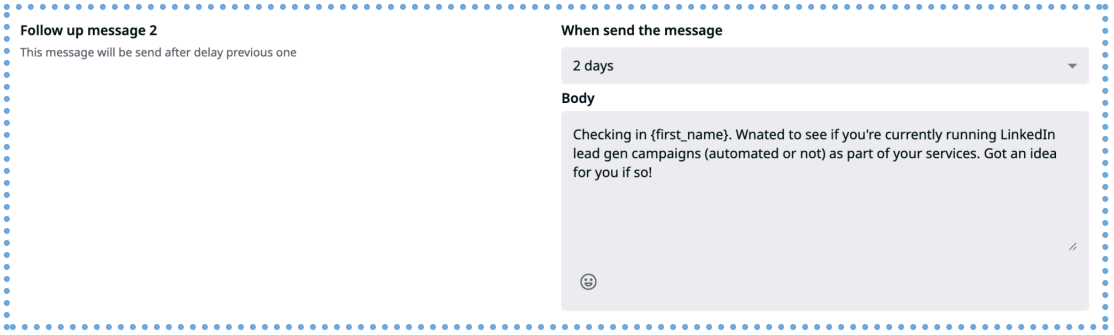
They say the money is in the follow ups, and they aren't wrong.

In the campaign screenshot I sent above, only 2% of people responded to my initial message. The remaining 33% of people responded to my FOLLOW UP messages! This is insane.

Meaning, if I hadn't followed up after the initial message, I would be missing out on 33% of total leads. This is one of the best examples I can give you to illustrate my point here.

Do the follow ups. Do the follow ups. Do the follow ups.

I recommend sending 2 follow ups maximum, each spaced 2 or 3 days apart. You want to make sure you are following up, but not spamming people. As far as language goes, there are many approaches to take here, but the simplest way is to just continue to be curious and/or add more value (i.e. send resources, etc.)

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## BONUS TIP: Sharing Your Content in Your Outreach ⭐

### The Best Growth Hack for Better Connections 🚀

I'm going to let you in on what I think is one of the most effective ways to get & convert leads on LinkedIn using both your outreach AND your content.

It's so simple that everyone can do, though I do not see many people doing it.

The growth hack is: Send your relevant LinkedIn posts to your connections via your outreach.

Why is this a growth hack?

Because not only are you providing your new connection/lead with a super valuable piece of content that could benefit them, but you are also getting them invested into your content & your offer as a whole.

This is truly the best of both worlds. Sharing value without being spammy. It's a salesperson's dream.

You can use a simple initial message like:

*"Hey {firstName} - I just made a post last week that I thought you might find useful, here's the link: {link}. Let me know if this is helpful?"*

**"Hey {name},**
**I just made a post last week that I thought you might find useful, here's the link: {link}.**
**Let me know if this is helpful?"**

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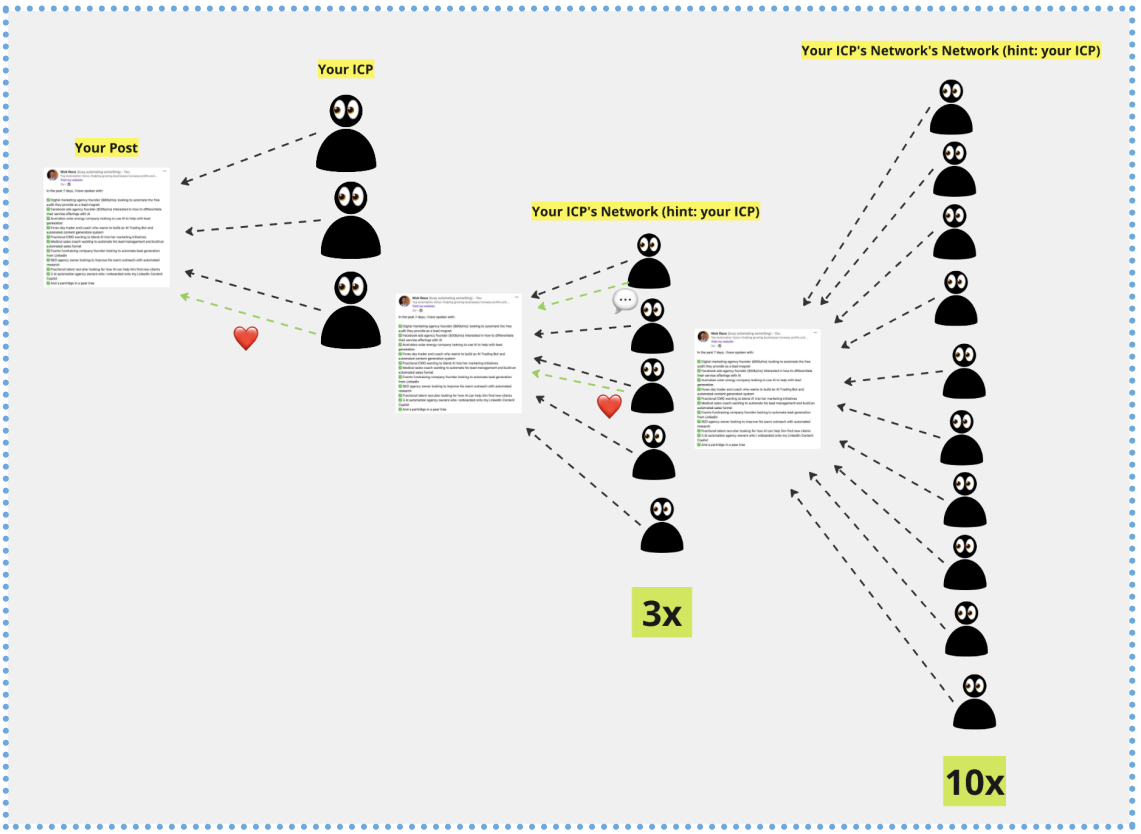
# Building Your Engagement Strategy 👥

Beyond automated outreach sequences, you need an always-on strategy for engaging prospects through relevant commentary.This organic engagement attracts potential customers already within your network while reinforcing your expertise.

Like all things on LinkedIn, the goal of engagement is to get your profile seen by more and more potential customers. When you engage on LinkedIn, people see your comments, and will decide if your profile looks worthwhile enough to watch content & follow.

**PRO TIP:** When a big LinkedIn profile comments on your post, you get shown to their entire follower base. This is a major growth hack.

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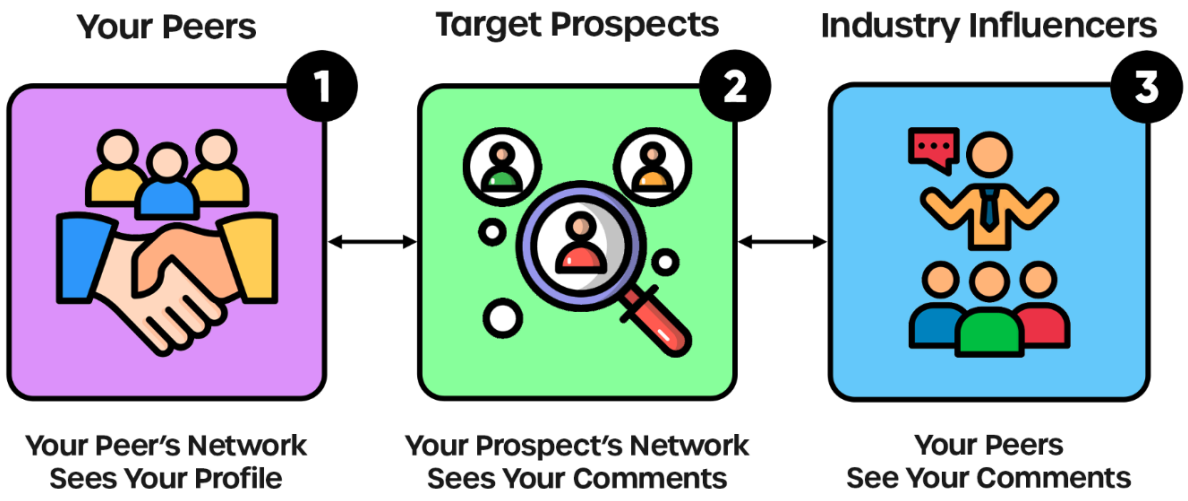
## The 3-Tiered Engagement Framework 🤑

Here is a 3-tiered engagement framework focused on AI topics:




### Tier 1: Engage With Your Peers 👥

Comment on relevant posts from close connections and strategic partners. Share insights and continue thought leadership conversations.

*You comment → Your comment shown in your peer's feed → Your peer' network sees your profile*

### Tier 2: Engage With Target Prospects 🎯

Proactively engage on relevant content posted by key prospects and accounts from your target lists. Increase familiarity.

*You comment → Your prospect sees your comment → Your prospect's network sees your comment*

### Tier 3: Engage With Industry Influencers 📈

Connect with recognized experts and thought leaders related to your AI automation field, as well as influencers within your ICP's industry. Remember, your ICP will likely be following influencers that they care about in their niche. You need to show up there to be seen.

*You comment → Peers in your industry see your comment → Your peers see your profile*

This tiered engagement strategy nurtures relationships across three key audiences:

1. **Partners** - Strengthen alignment and explore co-marketing opportunities
2. **Prospects** - Increase awareness and familiarity within target accounts
3. **Influencers** - Establish credibility and authority around AI

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The goal is to organically integrate your brand into conversations around how AI and automation drive business value - while directing that commentary toward individuals and accounts with the highest lead potential.

Here are some best practices to follow:

- Sort LinkedIn feeds by content topics to easily discover relevant AI posts and commentary
- Provide unique perspectives, data-driven insights and thought-provoking questions
- Share examples demonstrating real-world AI applications
- Comment first on posts from peers and strategic partners to spark insightful discussions

This establishes your agency as a recognized expert and thought leader within your space.

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## Video Recap 🏁

Let's recap the key concepts we covered:

- ✅ Outreach and engagement attract and convert targeted prospects
- ✅ Identify high-value accounts using advanced Sales Navigator filters
- ✅ Automate personalized outreach sequences across channels
- ✅ Optimize messaging to showcase AI value proposition
- ✅ Organically participate in AI-focused discussions
- ✅ Share and personalize external AI content with prospects

This is how you add gas to your LinkedIn growth vehicle.

## Now… It's Your Turn 👊

You have just completed the final video in this module. Good work. I know it was a lot of information.

But now, the real work begins.

You have everything you need to get started growing your AAA on LinkedIn. You know the best practices, and you know what needs to be done.

It is now your turn.

Do not make the mistake that 80% of people reading this will do - which is do nothing.

Progress requires action. And action is what you must take.

To help you do this, I've compiled a **30-Day Action Plan Guide** that you can use to track your progress and ensure you're following the guidelines that we've set in this module.

If you follow it, along with all of the guidance I've given you here, you will succeed.

I wish you all the best.

Go crush it.

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